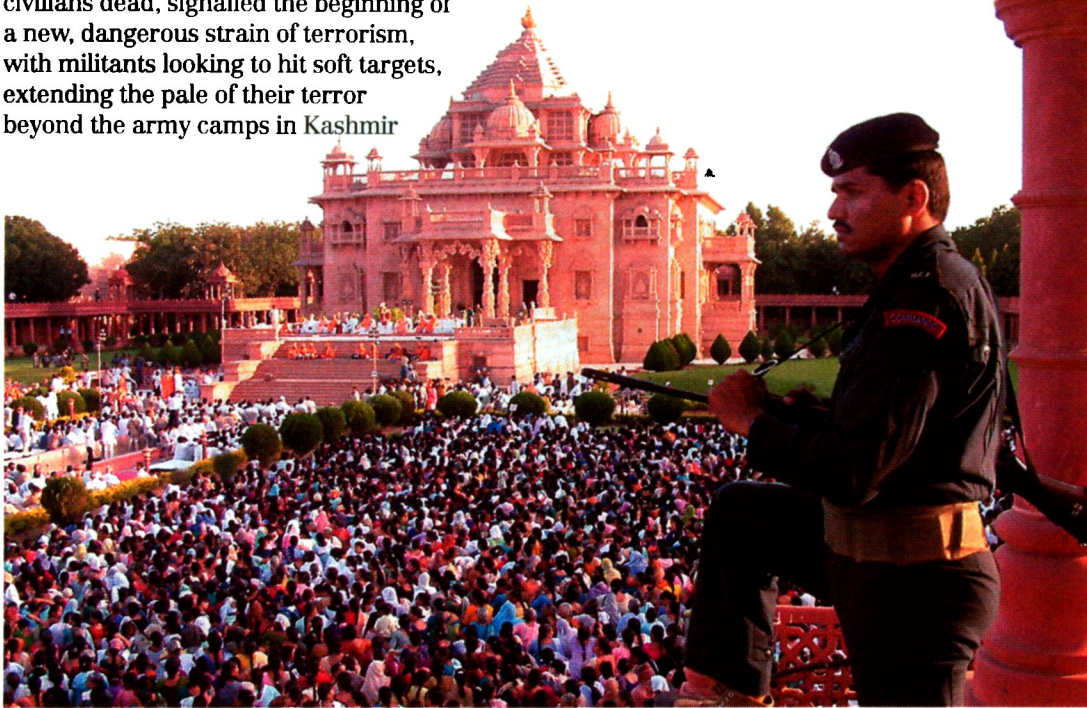


Temple Trauma

The terrorist attack on the Akshardham Temple on September 24 which left 29 civilians dead, signalled the beginning of a new, dangerous strain of terrorism, with militants looking to hit soft targets, extending the pale of their terror beyond the army camps in Kashmir



SHAIKSH RAVAL

"THE MAJOR TASK IS TO INTEGRATE THE NATION."

A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

The 2002 presidential race seemed to all to be a fight between P.C. Alexander, incumbent K.R. Narayanan and Vice-President Krishan Kant. So it was a surprise when on June 10, India's missile man, A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, emerged as the consensus candidate. While it was a political coup that the ruling National Democratic Alliance had pulled off by suggesting a rank outsider—that too from the minority community—Kalam's credentials were impeccable, being seen by the strong middle-class as a man of honour, besides being one of the great scientific minds of our time.



DILIP BANERJEE

- Euro notes and coins were issued in all major countries of mainland Europe.
- On June 4, Queen Elizabeth II (below) and



the Duke of Edinburgh rode in a gold state coach to mark her 50 years on the throne.

- The US invasion of Afghanistan began as it searched for 9/11 mastermind, Osama Bin Laden. The operation, called Enduring Freedom, marked the beginning of the US War on Terrorism. The US and Britain led the aerial bombings, with support by the Afghan Northern Alliance and supplemented by NATO troops.

Rs 50

crore was spent by Sanjay Leela Bhansali on his film *Devdas*. This was a remake of the Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay classic and was touted as the most expensive film at its time. It starred Aishwarya Rai and Shah Rukh Khan in lead roles.